

COIFFEURS

DE LA FRANCOPHONIE

MAYO

A CURATED CANVAS OF FRENCH HAUTE COUTURE, HERITAGE FASHION, TIMELESS LANDMARKS, CULTURAL CURIOSITIES, AND CROSS-CONTINENTAL ARTISTRY. STEP INSIDE A CELESTIAL SCRAPBOOK OF FLAVORS, FABRICS, AND FASCINATING STORIES—WHERE THE ELEGANCE OF FRANCE MEETS THE VIBRANCE OF INDIA.

Welcome to the French Society of
Mayo College, Ajmer.
Tradition. Honour. Excellence.
Vive la francophonie!

IMPORT RANDOM

MAYO = ("MAYO COLLEGE AJMER" - 150 YEARS
OF "EXCELLENCE") - "TRADITION, HONOUR,
EXCELLENCE.")

FRENCH = ("VIVE LA FRANCOPHONIE!", "LA VIE
EST BELLE", "L'ART DE VIVRE À LA
FRANÇAISE.")

WELCOME TO THE FRENCH SOCIETY OF
MAYO COLLEGE AJMER.")

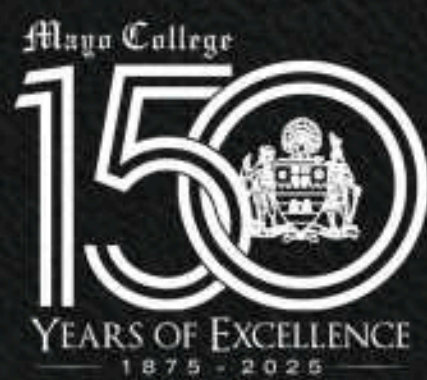
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INTERRANDOM.CHoice(FRENCH)

MAYO
COLLEGE
AJMER

ALLEZ MAYO







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Principal's MESSAGE



MR SAURAV
SINHA

I'm delighted to present Couleurs de la Francophonie, a magazine that uses our students' voices to highlight the diversity, beauty, and inventiveness of the French-speaking world.

As Mayo College marks 150 glorious years, this magazine reflects what our institution truly stands for— learning that goes beyond textbooks, and an education that opens young minds to new cultures, languages, and ideas. It is encouraging to observe how our students have embraced French as a means of connecting with a broader range of art, history, and expression, rather than merely as a subject.

The passion, creativity, and hard work of our young students are evident on every page of Couleurs de la Francophonie. Their work serves as a reminder that language has the capacity to foster understanding, celebrate diversity, and unite people.

I congratulate the French Department and all the students who contributed to this wonderful initiative.

Head of Department's MESSAGE



MR KUNAL
KUMAR

It fills me with immense pride and joy to see Couleurs de la Francophonie come together as a beautiful celebration of language, culture, and creativity. This magazine is more than just a collection of articles— it is the voice of our students, their imagination, and their growing love for French.

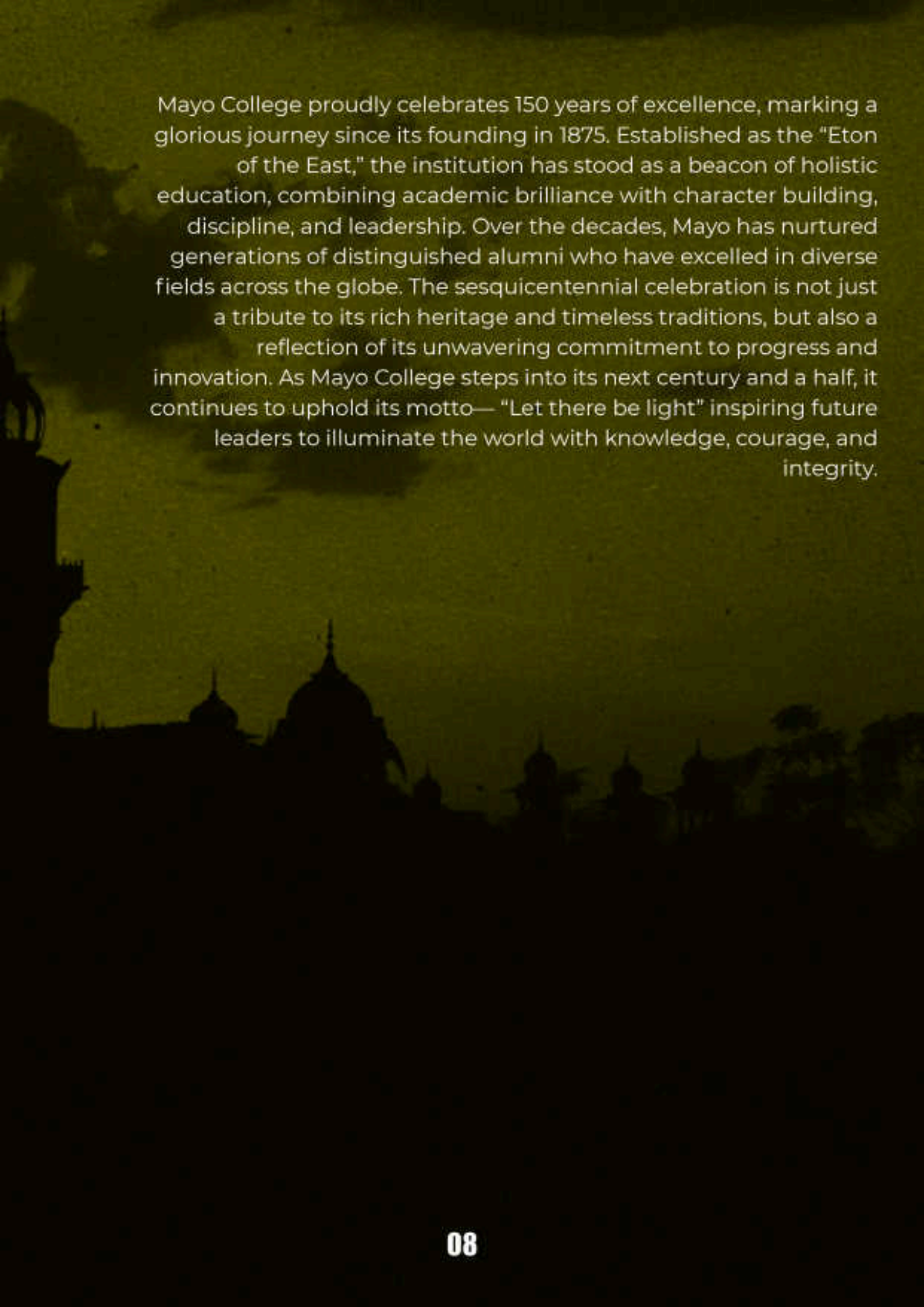
Learning a language is not only about grammar and vocabulary; it is about discovering new ways of thinking, feeling, and seeing the world. Through this project, our students have explored the rich heritage, cuisine, art, cinema, and many more things of France and the Francophone world— while reflecting on how deeply our Indian culture resonates with the same values of beauty, unity, and expression.

As I turned the pages, I was struck by the originality and voice of all the students- their enthusiasm, dedication, and artistic spirit — and by the support of my colleagues for their constant encouragement and guidance. Couleurs de la Francophonie represents the very essence of learning: curiosity, collaboration, and creativity.

I hope this magazine continues to inspire young learners to celebrate languages and to find joy in cultural exchange.



Mayo College
150

The background of the page is a photograph showing the silhouettes of several domes and spires of a large building, likely Mayo College, against a bright, hazy sky at sunset or sunrise. The sky has a warm, golden-yellow glow. The building's features are dark and detailed against the lighter sky.

Mayo College proudly celebrates 150 years of excellence, marking a glorious journey since its founding in 1875. Established as the “Eton of the East,” the institution has stood as a beacon of holistic education, combining academic brilliance with character building, discipline, and leadership. Over the decades, Mayo has nurtured generations of distinguished alumni who have excelled in diverse fields across the globe. The sesquicentennial celebration is not just a tribute to its rich heritage and timeless traditions, but also a reflection of its unwavering commitment to progress and innovation. As Mayo College steps into its next century and a half, it continues to uphold its motto— “Let there be light” inspiring future leaders to illuminate the world with knowledge, courage, and integrity.



bienvenue readers...

Get ready to *dive* into the *heart of France*— a land of *history, passion, and culture*. In this magazine, we take you on a *journey through France's timeless heritage*, its **iconic sports**, and the **traditions** that continue to *inspire the world*.

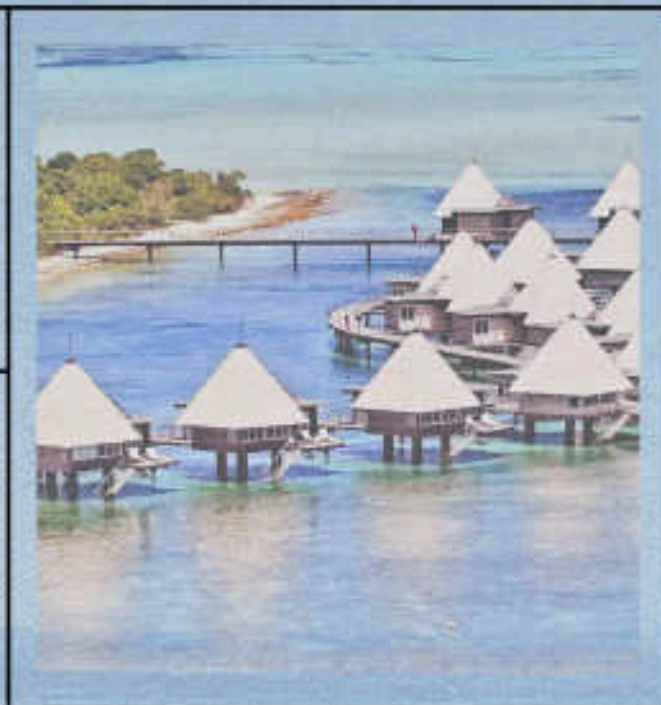
Discover the *stories* behind *famous landmarks*, the *energy of French sports*, and the *charm of everyday life* that makes France so **unique**. *Each page is a window* into a country where **art, adventure, and pride** come together.

So, *open your minds*, let your *curiosity lead the way*, and *join us* as we *celebrate everything* that makes France truly **extraordinary**.

Enjoy the journey!

NEW CALEDONIA

ARTICLE BY MS. LAURENCE LEDUC
FRENCH VISITING FACULTY
AT MAYO COLLEGE



Among the French territories scattered in the Pacific Ocean, there's one called New-Caledonia. It's composed of a mainland and three main islets. Although the mainland is only 50 kilometers wide and a bit more than 500 kilometers long, it does have up to a few dozens of languages spoken.

The population is scarce, with fewer than 300 thousand, and nature still occupies a huge place. Due to the mixture of diverse ethnics, well-known dishes also come from many parts of the world, like lemon marinated raw fish (Polynesia), stuffed rolls called nem (Vietnam), the delicious Bougnat (earth-cooked meat with tubers), bakmi (stir-fried noodles with beans and chicken) from Indonesia and roasted beef from France. In addition to those, smoked eel, bats, and venison are also to be found.

When dealing with traditional Melanesian Weddings, cooked bananas are common and yams are often offered as presents.

It's the groom's uncles by his mother's side who look after the whole ceremony. Living in open air is a style, so people enjoy picnicking, diving, fishing, hunting, going to beaches and practicing outdoor activities. Many Japanese couples have chosen to spend their honeymoon in New Caledonia because of its quietness and pristine waters.

It's not heaven but it's very close to the Great Barrier Reef, the World's biggest coral reef.

MERCI!

French is the fervour,
French is the culture,
French is the fashion—
It is the passion!
That's why it shines as a global sensation.
French is the glamour,
French is the glory,
As it tells the tale of Liberty, Equality, Fraternity—
A priceless gift to world history!

LE FRANÇAIS

A WORLDWIDE SENSATION

ARTICLE BY MRS. SAMAGATA MAJUMDAR

The French Language: A Bridge Across Cultures

French began as Latin in ancient Gaul and evolved through centuries of influence, especially from the Franks. By the 9th century, it had formed its own identity, and by the 17th century, it had become the language of diplomacy, literature, and art.

Global Acceptance

Today, French is spoken by over 300 million people on five continents and is the official language of 29 countries. It is one of the six official languages of the United Nations and the second most learned language worldwide. Nearly 45% of English vocabulary has French roots, and French remains the only language, along with English, that is taught in every country in the world.

Indo-French Bonhomie

India and France share a long and meaningful history—from the French trading posts in Puducherry and Chandannagar to modern collaborations in defence, technology, clean energy, artificial intelligence, climate action, and the Indo-Pacific region. Cultural festivals such as Namaste France and Bonjour India continue to strengthen this friendship.

Conclusion

French is more than an academic subject. It is a journey through beauty, intellect, and global connection—from the boulevards of Puducherry to the cafés of Paris. In the 21st century, giving priority to French education means empowering students to become confident global citizens and true globetrotters.

LCF 2025



This year, **Mayo College** successfully hosted the 12th edition of **Le Concours de la Francophonie du Mayo** from **October 3rd to October 5th, 2025**. Students from prestigious schools across India, along with four international schools, enthusiastically participated in LCF du Mayo 2025.



Mr Jatinder Singh, Deputy Attaché for Cooperation in French Language & education at the Embassy of France in India, graced the Opening Ceremony as Chief Guest. **His Excellency Ambassador Didier Vanderhasselt**, Ambassador of Belgium to India, was the Chief Guest for the Closing Ceremony. **Chef Thierry Le Baut**, Academic Director at Le Cordon Bleu, Gurugram, and **Prof. Kiran Chaudhry**, Professor at Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi, were the Guests of Honour.

THE *Doorknobs* '25



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HEAD OF MANAGEMENT



SURYAANSH KHANDELWAL
SECRETARY

FRENCH EXCHANGE

WHAT IS AN *exchange?*

A STUDENT EXCHANGE ALLOWS STUDENTS TO LIVE AND STUDY IN EACH OTHER'S COUNTRIES, ATTEND CLASSES, STAY WITH HOST FAMILIES, EXPERIENCE NEW CULTURES FIRSTHAND, AND BUILD LIFELONG GLOBAL FRIENDSHIPS.



THE STUDENTS OF MAYO COLLEGE PARTICIPATED IN A TRANSFORMATIVE TWO-WEEK FRENCH CULTURAL AND LANGUAGE EXCHANGE PROGRAMME FROM APRIL 30 TO MAY 17, 2025 AT SAINTE MARIE DE CHAVAGNES, FRANCE. THE IMMERSIVE EXPERIENCE ALLOWED STUDENTS TO STAY WITH FRENCH HOST FAMILIES, OFFERING THEM A UNIQUE AND AUTHENTIC GLIMPSE INTO EVERYDAY FRENCH LIFE, LANGUAGE, AND TRADITIONS.

DURING THE EXCHANGE, STUDENTS EXPLORED MONACO, THE LEGENDARY HUB OF FORMULA 1 RACING, AND VISITED SEVERAL ICONIC FRENCH LANDMARKS. HIGHLIGHTS INCLUDED THE CANNES FILM FESTIVAL AREA, PRESTIGIOUS BOARDING SCHOOLS, AND HOSPITALITY INSTITUTIONS IN SWITZERLAND, PROVIDING VALUABLE INSIGHTS INTO GLOBAL EDUCATION AND INDUSTRY STANDARDS.

A POIGNANT MOMENT OF THE TRIP WAS THE VISIT TO THE **MAZARGUES INDIAN WAR CEMETERY IN MARSEILLE**, WHERE STUDENTS PAID THEIR **RESPECTS TO INDIAN SOLDIERS** WHO SERVED IN FRANCE DURING **WORLD WAR I**—A SITE RECENTLY HONOURED BY INDIA'S PRIME MINISTER IN FEBRUARY 2025.

CULTURAL ENRICHMENT CONTINUED WITH A GUIDED TOUR OF THE **FRAGONARD PERFUME HOUSE IN GRASSE**, A VISIT TO A **TRADITIONAL CHOCOLATERIE**, AND AN UNFORGETTABLE **KAYAKING ADVENTURE IN THE MEDITERRANEAN SEA OFF THE COAST OF CANNES**. STUDENTS ALSO EXPLORED A NEARBY ISLAND, WITH EACH ACTIVITY OFFERING OPPORTUNITIES FOR REFLECTION, LEARNING, AND PERSONAL GROWTH.

MORE THAN JUST TRAVEL, THIS PROGRAMME EMBODIED "**EDUCATION BEYOND BORDERS**"—FOSTERING INTERCULTURAL **UNDERSTANDING**, **GLOBAL AWARENESS**, AND **LIFELONG FRIENDSHIPS**. THE EXCHANGE HAS LEFT STUDENTS WITH A **DEEP APPRECIATION FOR FRENCH HERITAGE** AND A TREASURE TROVE OF **UNFORGETTABLE MEMORIES**.



BONJOUR

From Mayo



Du 28 février au 11 mars 2025, douze lycéens de notre établissement ont la chance de vivre une expérience unique en Inde, au prestigieux Mayo College (Ajmer, Rajasthan).

Dès leur arrivée au Mayo College, nos élèves ont été chaleureusement accueillis par leurs correspondants indiens. Fondé en 1875, cet établissement prestigieux, souvent comparé à Eton en Angleterre, leur a ouvert ses portes pour une immersion dans son quotidien.

Au programme des premiers jours : cours de musique indienne où nos lycéens ont découvert le sitar et le tabla sous la direction des professeurs passionnés, découverte de la gastronomie, visite des écuries, pratique du golf (sur le campus), ateliers d'art, initiation au yoga, cours de ferronnerie et d'ébénisterie...

Lors de la soirée de gala, nous avons eu l'honneur de chanter, avec les élèves, une chanson en hindi sur l'amitié devant nos hôtes du Mayo College. Un beau moment de partage et d'émotion, célébrant les liens qui nous unissent au-delà des frontières.

Par ailleurs, un des temps forts du séjour fut sans conteste leur participation à un mariage indien où certaines lycéennes étaient drapées dans des saris.

Ce moment privilégié leur a offert un aperçu unique de la richesse des traditions indiennes et de l'hospitalité locale.

Après cette première partie du séjour, nous prendrons la route pour explorer le Rajasthan, une région connue pour ses palais majestueux. Le voyage s'achèvera en apothéose avec la visite du Taj Mahal, à Agra.

Au mois de Mai, nous recevrons les correspondants indiens. Ils seront accueillis dans les familles des lycéens ayant participé à l'échange scolaire.

Ce voyage, qui est une succession de moments forts en émotions, restera sans aucun doute une expérience marquante pour nos élèves, qui reviendront avec des souvenirs impérissables et une ouverture nouvelle sur le monde.





FRENCH *Innovation*



A FRENCH INNOVATION

1895

CINEMATOGRAPHY

Cinematography

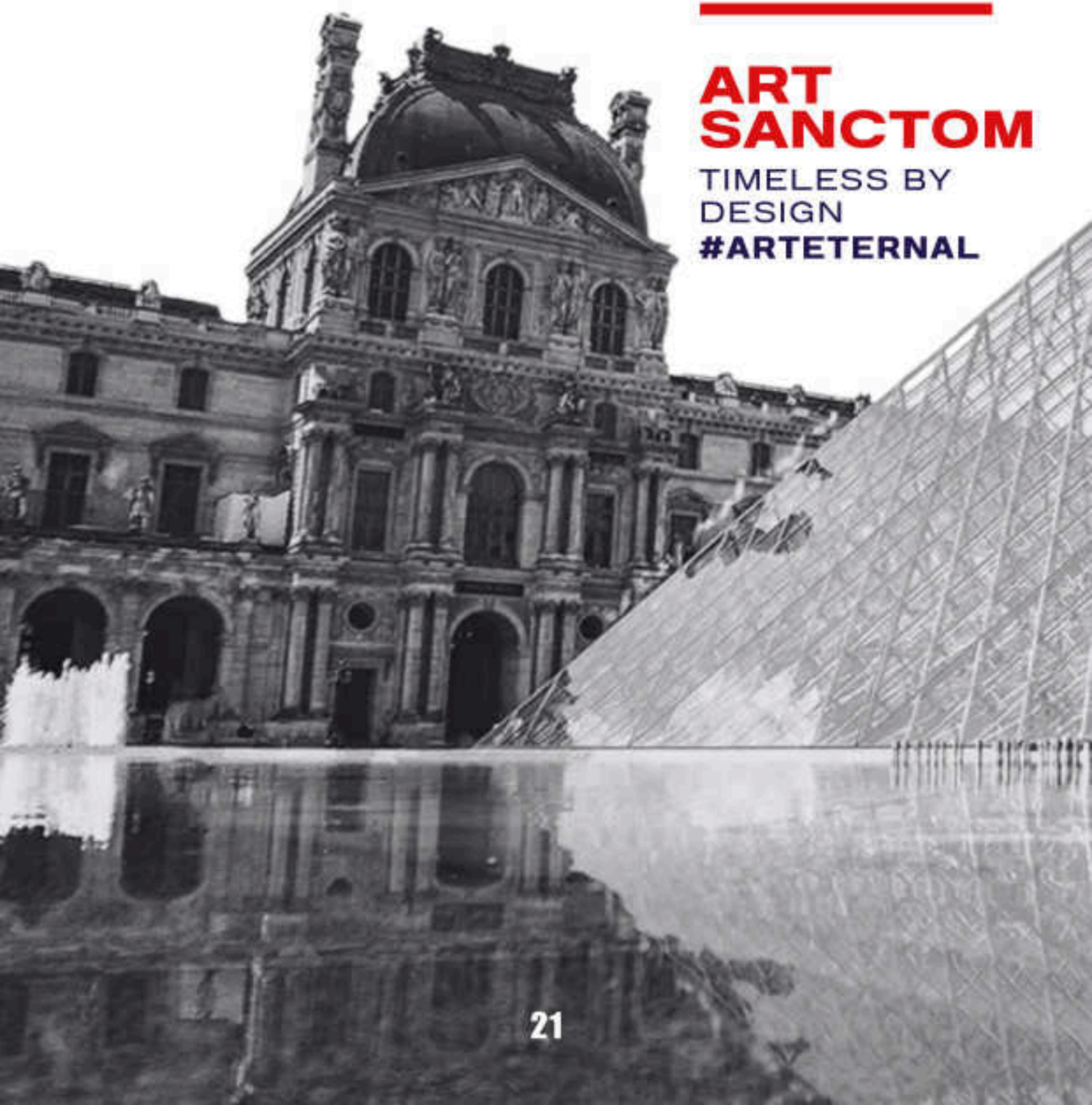
Cinematography- the art of motion pictures- was born in France, a country that gave the world the magic of the moving image. In the late 19th century, two pioneering brothers, Auguste and Louis Lumière, revolutionized visual storytelling by inventing the Cinématographe in 1895. This ingenious device could record, develop, and project films— a groundbreaking leap from still photography to motion pictures.

“WHERE ART BREATHES”

ALL OLD
MASTERPIECES

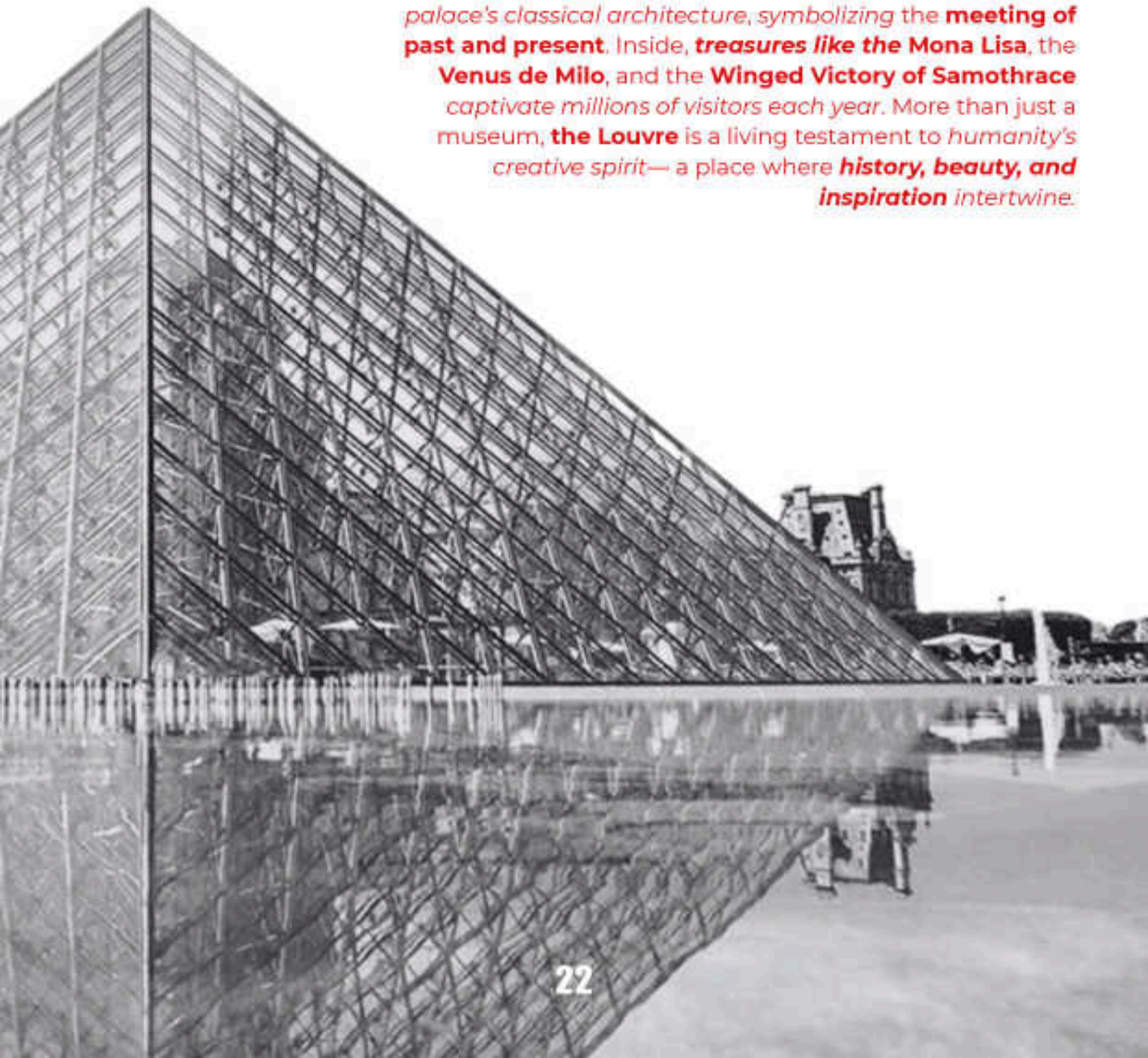
**ART
SANCTOM**

TIMELESS BY
DESIGN
#ARTETERNAL



MUSÉE DU LOUVRE

The **Musée du Louvre**, located in the heart of *Paris*, stands **as one of the world's most celebrated museums** and a symbol of timeless art and culture. Once a **royal palace**, the **Louvre** now houses an extraordinary collection that spans centuries—from **ancient civilizations** to the **grand masterpieces** of the Renaissance. Its **iconic glass pyramid**, designed by **I. M. Pei**, forms a striking contrast with the palace's classical architecture, symbolizing the **meeting of past and present**. Inside, **treasures like the Mona Lisa**, the **Venus de Milo**, and the **Winged Victory of Samothrace** captivate millions of visitors each year. More than just a museum, the **Louvre** is a living testament to *humanity's creative spirit*—a place where **history, beauty, and inspiration** intertwine.





THE MONACO GRAND PRIX 2025



Lando Norris claimed a spectacular victory for McLaren, taking pole position and converting it into a flawless win. His teammate, Oscar Piastri, completed a strong double podium, underlining McLaren's dominant form this season. Norris's win was a *masterclass in precision and strategy*, particularly in managing the tricky tire compounds and timing his pit stops *perfectly* on Monaco's unforgiving streets. Charles Leclerc fought hard for a home podium in his Ferrari, but Norris's *combination of speed and tactical nous* proved *unstoppable*, cementing McLaren's status as a serious championship contender.

The 2025 Monaco Grand Prix offered all the *drama and prestige* fans expect from the iconic street circuit. With its narrow corners, harbor-side backdrop, and the new two-stop rule, strategy and precision were key, keeping spectators on the edge of their seats from start to finish. **Qualifying set the stage with record-breaking laps**, and the race unfolded as a thrilling battle at the front.

Alain PROST

Alain Prost, often called '**Le Professeur**' for his *analytical driving style*, remains one of **Formula 1's most masterful tacticians**.

Across a career that spanned the **1980s and early 1990s**, Prost captured **four World Championships** and **51 Grand Prix victories**, achievements built on *precision, consistency*, and a *deep understanding of race strategy*. His smooth driving made him a **sharp contrast** to more aggressive rivals, yet it was exactly this *methodical approach* that kept him at the *front of the field year after year*.

Perhaps most famously, **Prost's rivalry** with **Ayrton Senna** *defined an era*— sometimes *bitter, always electrifying*— as the two pushed each other to new heights and occasionally *beyond the limits of sportsmanship*. After retiring in **1993** as the then— *most successful driver in F1 history*, Prost continued to shape the sport through **team management and commentary**. His legacy endures as a benchmark of *intelligence, discipline, and longevity in motor racing*.

PARIS

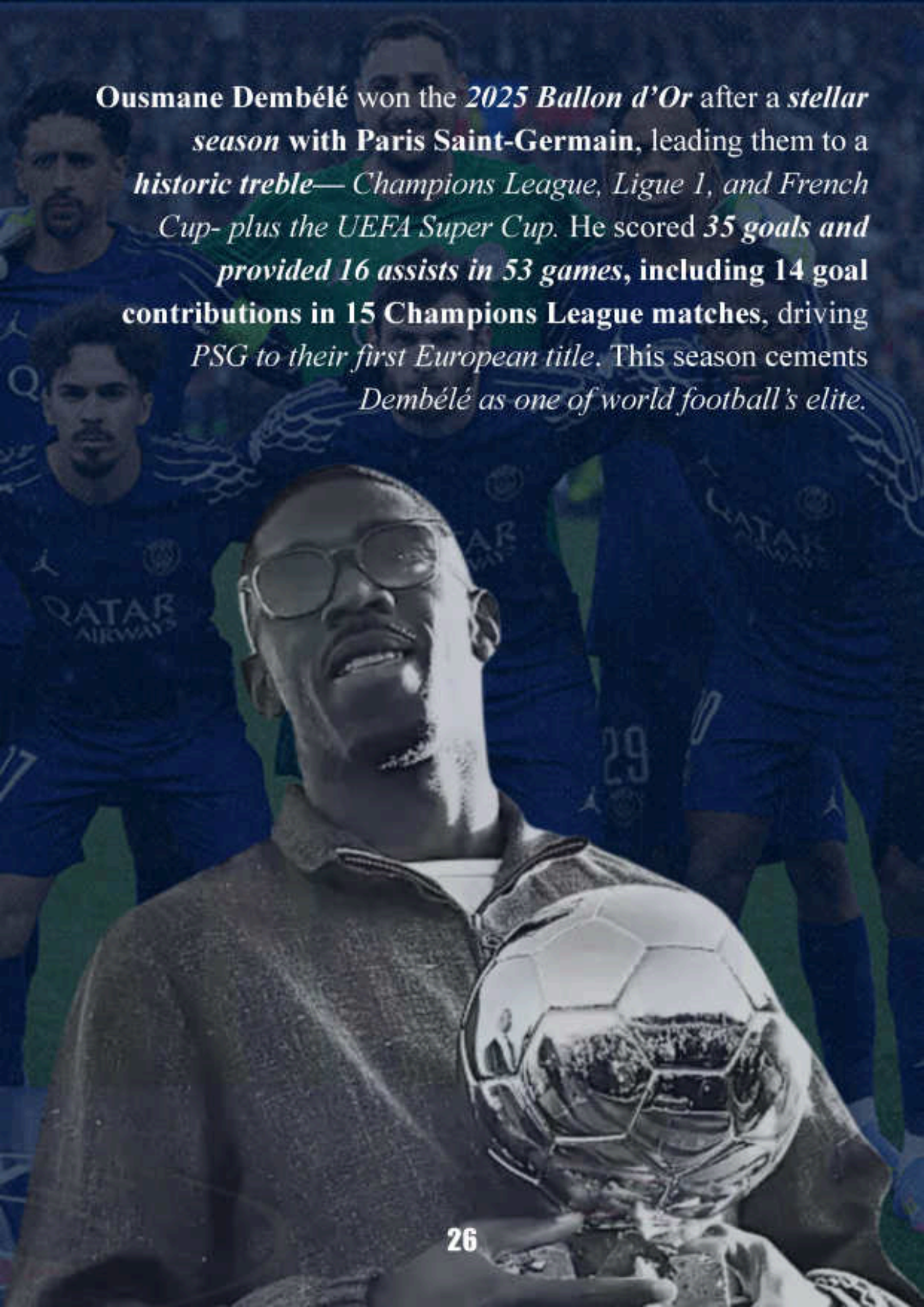


SAINT - GERMAIN

Paris Saint-Germain (PSG) *made history* in the **2025** season by **completing a European treble**—winning *Ligue 1*, the *Coupe de France*, and the *UEFA Champions League*. They are **only the 11th team in history to achieve this** rare feat. Under **Luis Enrique**, *PSG dominated French football* and **finally conquered Europe** after years of falling just short.

The team's success was driven by the brilliance of Ousmane Dembélé supported by *Vitinha, Marquinhos*, and a *strong all-around squad* that combined flair with tactical maturity.

The triumph places PSG among **Europe's elite**, joining **legendary treble winners** such as *Manchester United (1999)*, *Barcelona (2009, 2015)*, *Inter Milan (2010)*, and *Bayern Munich (2013, 2020)*.

A composite image featuring Ousmane Dembélé in the foreground, smiling and holding the 2025 Ballon d'Or trophy. He is wearing a grey zip-up sweater over a white shirt and glasses. The background is a collage of several Paris Saint-Germain players in their blue home kits, with 'QATAR AIRWAYS' visible on the front. The overall tone is celebratory and professional.

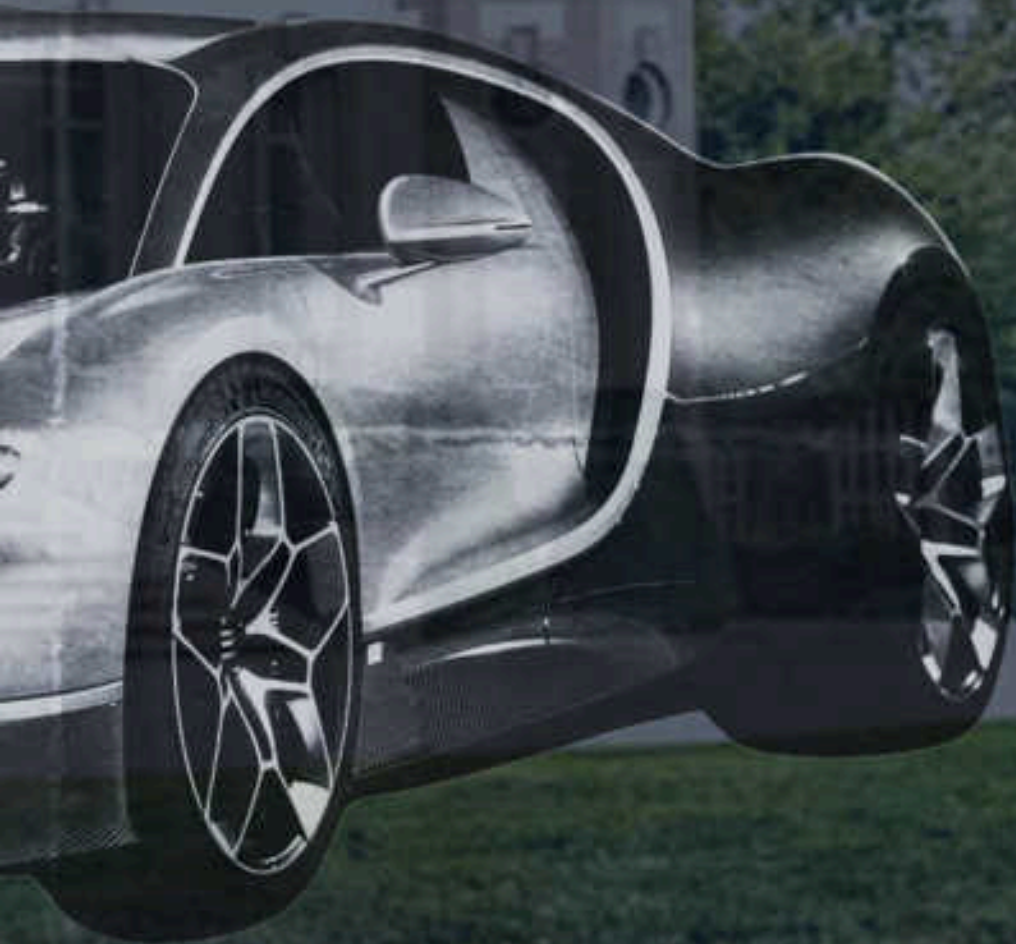
Ousmane Dembélé won the *2025 Ballon d'Or* after a *stellar season with Paris Saint-Germain*, leading them to a *historic treble— Champions League, Ligue 1, and French Cup- plus the UEFA Super Cup*. He scored *35 goals and provided 16 assists in 53 games, including 14 goal contributions in 15 Champions League matches*, driving *PSG to their first European title*. This season cements *Dembélé as one of world football's elite*.



“NOTHING IS TOO BEAUTIFUL,
NOTHING IS TOO EXPENSIVE.”



Bugatti, one of the most iconic names in the world of luxury automobiles, was **founded in France** by the **Italian-born engineer Ettore Bugatti in 1909**. The company was **established in Molsheim, a small town in the Alsace region of France**, which was then a hub of innovation and craftsmanship. **Ettore Bugatti** combined artistic design with advanced engineering, creating cars that were **not only fast but also elegant masterpieces**. Bugatti's early models, such as the **Type 35**, became legendary for their success in racing and their unmatched beauty. Over the years, **Bugatti has continued to symbolize French excellence, precision, and innovation in the automotive world, blending art and speed in every creation.**



FASHION



GRADE BALANCED FILM 6710

GRADE BALANCED FILM 6710

GRADE BALANCED FILM 6710



GRADE BALANCED FILM 6710

2A

2B

7A

1B

0A

GRADE BALANCED FILM 6710

GRADE BALANCED FILM 6710



6

9A

9B

8A

9B

7A

7B

6A

6B

5A

5B

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GRADE BALANCED FILM 6710



13A

13B

12A

12B

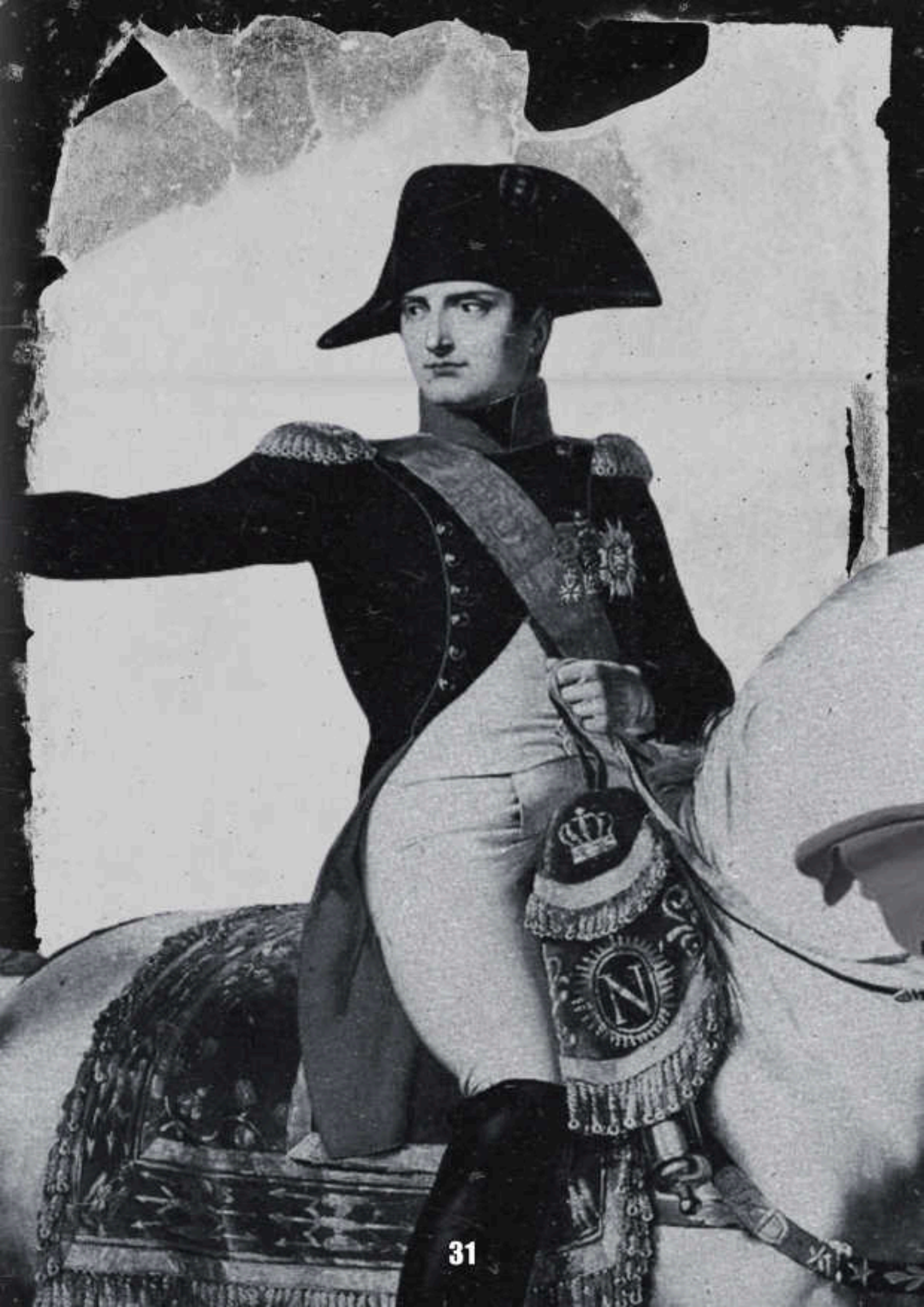
11A

11B

10A

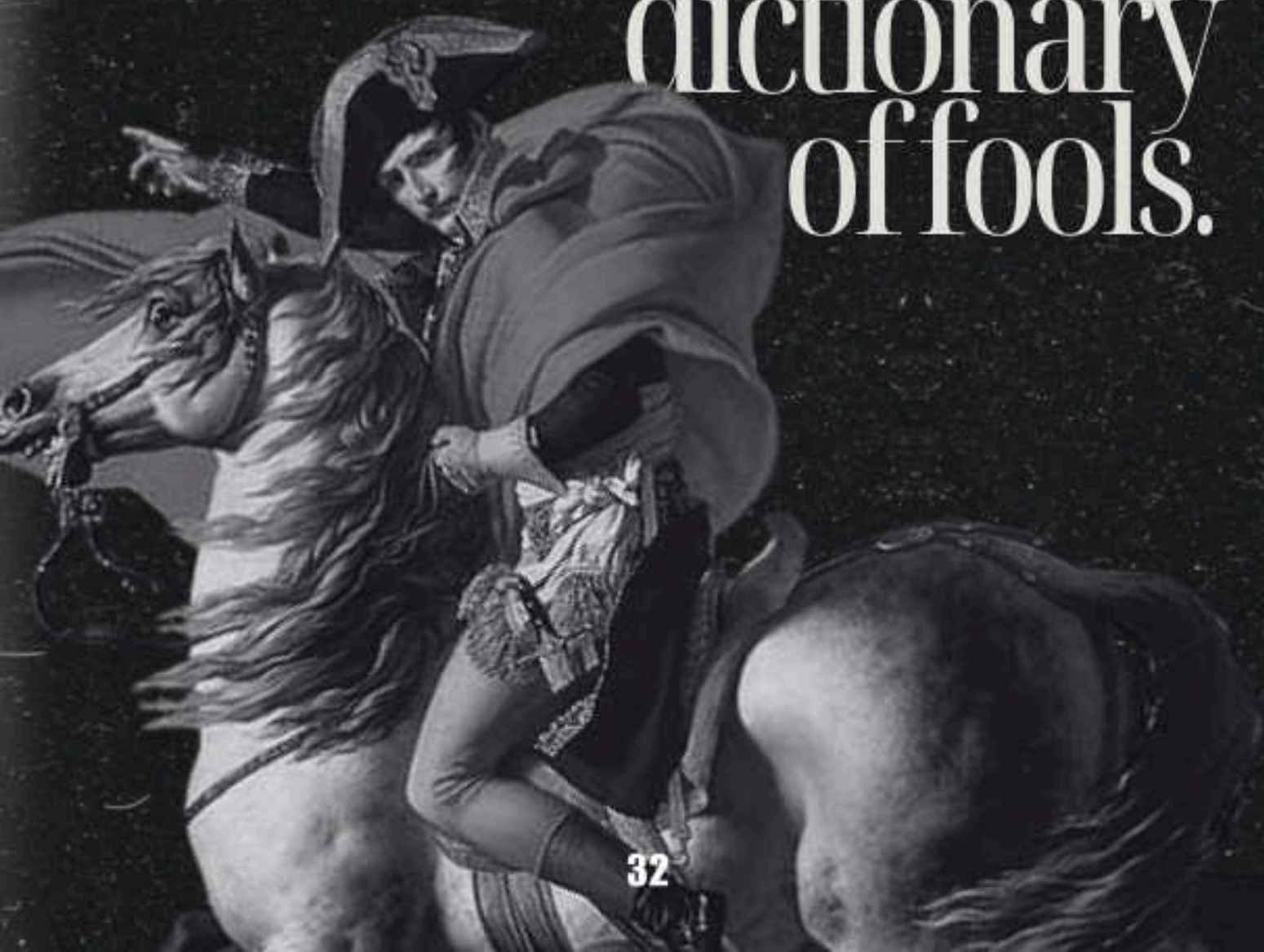
10B

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SAID BY
NAPOLEON BONAPARTE

Impossible
is a word
to be
found only
in the
dictionary
of fools.



Music



Barrel organ

ORGUE DE BARBARIE

The *orgue de barbarie*, or **French barrel organ**, remains a *nostalgic emblem of old Parisian life*. Its **soft, wistful** tunes once floated through **narrow streets** and **lively squares**, played by **wandering musicians** who brought their *music to the people*.

Each gentle turn of the **handle** set the *instrument's wooden cylinder* in **motion**, triggering *pipes* that sang with bright yet tender tones. There was a **mix of joy and sadness** in its sound—a *handmade melody* carried on the air.

Though few remain today, the **barrel organ** still evokes the warmth of an era when *music was crafted* by hand and powered by the simple motion of a **crank**.



DJ SNAKE

DJ SNAKE ENCORE



DJ SNAKE, BORN WILLIAM SAMI ÉTIENNE GRIGAHCINE IN PARIS, IS ONE OF FRANCE'S MOST INFLUENTIAL AND INTERNATIONALLY ACCLAIMED MUSIC PRODUCERS AND DJs. KNOWN FOR HIS ELECTRIFYING BEATS AND BOUNDARY-PUSHING COLLABORATIONS, HE ROSE TO GLOBAL FAME WITH HITS LIKE "TURN DOWN FOR WHAT", "LEAN ON", AND "TAKI TAKI." HIS MUSIC BLENDS ELEMENTS OF ELECTRONIC DANCE, HIP-HOP, AND POP, CREATING A DISTINCTIVE SOUND THAT DOMINATES FESTIVALS AND CHARTS WORLDWIDE. DJ SNAKE HAS WORKED WITH RENOWNED ARTISTS SUCH AS JUSTIN BIEBER, SELENA GOMEZ, AND CARDI B, SHOWCASING HIS ABILITY TO UNITE DIVERSE MUSICAL STYLES. PROUDLY REPRESENTING FRENCH ELECTRONIC MUSIC ON THE WORLD STAGE, DJ SNAKE CONTINUES TO REDEFINE MODERN SOUND AND INSPIRE A NEW GENERATION OF PRODUCERS WITH HIS INNOVATIVE CREATIVITY AND INTERNATIONAL APPEAL.



ÉDITH PIAF



ÉDITH PIAF, OFTEN CALLED "THE LITTLE SPARROW" OF FRANCE, REMAINS ONE OF THE MOST ICONIC AND BELOVED VOICES IN MUSIC HISTORY. BORN IN PARIS IN 1915, SHE ROSE FROM A LIFE OF HARDSHIP TO BECOME A GLOBAL SYMBOL OF FRENCH PASSION AND EMOTION. HER SONGS, SUCH AS "LA VIE EN ROSE", "NON, JE NE REGRETTE RIEN", AND "HYMNE À L'AMOUR", ARE TIMELESS EXPRESSIONS OF LOVE, SORROW, AND RESILIENCE. PIAF'S POWERFUL, HEARTFELT VOICE AND DRAMATIC PERFORMANCES CAPTURED THE SOUL OF PARIS, ENCHANTING AUDIENCES AROUND THE WORLD. EVEN DECADES AFTER HER PASSING, HER LEGACY ENDURES AS THE VOICE OF FRANCE — A TESTAMENT TO THE POWER OF ART BORN FROM STRUGGLE, LOVE, AND THE SPIRIT OF SURVIVAL.



LE CINÉMA *Français*

INDIAN FILMS SHINE AT THE 2025 CANNES FILM FESTIVAL

HOMEBOUND — NEERAJ GHAYWAN

Neeraj Ghaywan's *Homebound* premiered in the **Un Certain Regard** section and earned a nine-minute standing ovation. Starring **Janhvi Kapoor** and **Ishaan Khatter**, it follows **two friends from rural India** chasing their dreams amid social conflict—earning praise for its emotional realism.



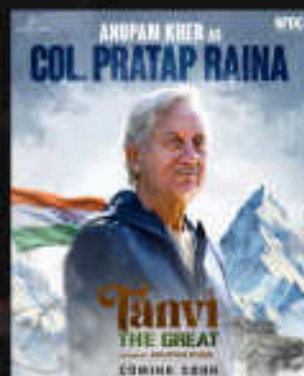
CHARAK — SHEILADITYA MOULIK

Bengali filmmaker Sheiladitya Moulik's *Charak*, inspired by the **Charak Puja** ritual, appeared in a Special Screening, exploring **faith** and **sacrifice** through a **culturally rooted** narrative.



TANVI THE GREAT — ANUPAM KHER

Veteran actor **Anupam Kher** made his directorial debut with *'Tanvi The Great'*, which premiered at the **Marché du Film**. Featuring **Iain Glen**, **Boman Irani**, and **Jackie Shroff**, it's an inspiring story of **hope** and **ambition**.



LCF DU MAYO 2025
XII EDITION

QUI ES-TU?

A MAYO COLLEGE
PRODUCTION 2025



a French psychological short film exploring *identity, delusion, and perception*, produced for Le Concours de la Francophonie du Mayo 2025.

+

+

CLAUDE

MONET



“je veux peindre la façon dont un oiseau chante”

**“ I WANT
TO PAINT THE
WAY A BIRD
SINGS ”**



CASSOULET

BON APPÉTIT!



Cassoulet is a rich, slow-cooked casserole from southern France, especially the towns of Castelnaudary, Carcassonne, and Toulouse. This comforting dish combines white beans with a mix of meats such as duck confit, pork, and Toulouse sausage, all simmered in a fragrant broth until tender and deeply flavorful.

Traditionally baked in an earthenware pot called a cassole, cassoulet develops a golden crust that's often broken and reformed several times during cooking to enhance its texture. Each region adds its own touch: Castelnaudary favors pork, Toulouse adds sausage, and Carcassonne may include lamb or partridge.

Served hot and hearty, Cassoulet embodies the rustic warmth of French country cooking—a timeless celebration of patience, tradition, and flavor.



RATATOUILLE

A vibrant vegetable **stew** from **Provence**, made with **tomatoes, zucchini, eggplant, bell peppers, onions**, and seasoned with herbs like thyme and rosemary. It's a **hearty and colorful celebration** of garden-fresh ingredients.



BOUILLABAISSE

A traditional **fish stew** from **Marseille**, made with a variety of fresh seafood, including **fish, shellfish, and aromatic herbs**, typically served with **rouille** (a garlic and saffron-flavored sauce) and **crusty bread**.



BAGUETTE

No French meal is complete **without the beloved baguette**, a long, thin loaf of French bread that has **become a symbol of French culinary culture**. **Recognized globally** for its crackling golden crust and airy, tender interior, the **baguette is baked fresh every day** in **bakeries across France**. Its simple ingredients: flour, water, yeast, and salt- belie the **craftsmanship** involved in shaping and scoring the **dough** to achieve the signature look and texture.



FRENCH WINE

French wine is celebrated across the world for its **outstanding quality, rich history, and remarkable variety**. Famous wine regions like **Bordeaux, Burgundy, Champagne, Alsace, the Loire Valley, and the Rhône Valley** each produce *unique styles* that reflect their **terroir**- the combination of **soil, climate, and landscape** that gives every wine its distinctive character. **Bordeaux is best known** for its bold red blends made from **Cabernet Sauvignon, Merlot, and Cabernet Franc**, while Burgundy shines with elegant *Pinot Noir* reds and *Chardonnay* whites. Champagne in northern France produces the world's **most famous sparkling wines**, crafted from *Chardonnay, Pinot Noir, and Pinot Meunier*. The **Loire Valley** is famous for its **crisp Sauvignon Blanc and Chenin Blanc**, while the **Rhône Valley** offers powerful reds made from **Syrah and Grenache**. Together, these regions make France a cornerstone of the global wine world, blending **centuries of tradition** with a **deep passion** for perfection.

UNESCO HERITAGE

SITES IN *France*

France's World Heritage sites span from prehistoric cave art to **Roman infrastructure**, Gothic cathedrals to engineering marvels of the **industrial age**, and from soaring natural landscapes to modern architectural achievements: for example the prehistoric decorated caves of the **Vézère valley**, the **Roman aqueduct Pont du Gard**, the medieval walled city of **Carcassonne**, the extraordinary Gothic **Chartres Cathedral**, the grand palace and gardens of **Versailles**, the canal network of **Canal du Midi**, the historic port city of **Bordeaux** ("Port of the Moon"), the alpine-Mediterranean landscape of **Causses & Cévennes**, the modern architectural sites of **Le Corbusier's works**, remote natural territories such as the **French Austral Lands and Seas**, and recent additions such as the **battle-site heritage of the First World War**. The common thread is "**outstanding universal value**" as defined by **UNESCO**: be it human artistic achievement, technological innovation, ecological processes, or landscapes shaped by human-nature interaction. Thus France's heritage is not a single era or style, but a rich tapestry from ancient to modern, from monumental to natural.



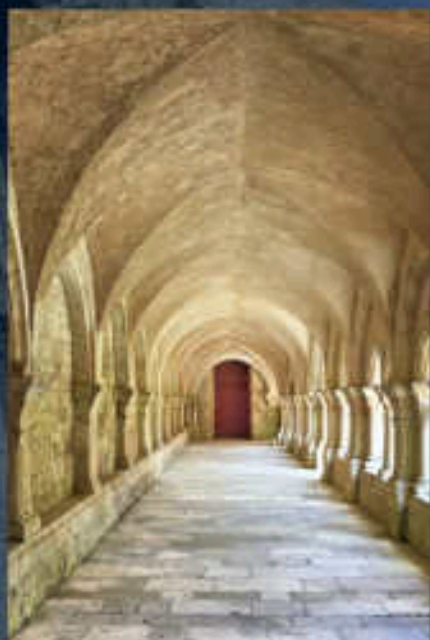
BASILIQUE SAINT-REMI, REIMS

A stunning **Romanesque-Gothic basilica** dating back to the **11th century**. It houses the **relics of Saint Remigius**, who baptized **Clovis I**, the *first king of the Franks*. Its **peaceful cloisters** and *historic chapels* make it a serene and significant site in **Reims**.



CHÂTEAU DE PIERREFONDS, OISE

A magnificent medieval castle **restored in the 19th century** by architect **Viollet-le-Duc**. With its *fairy-tale towers, drawbridge, and scenic forest surroundings*, it's a **magical site** often overlooked by visitors rushing to the more famous castles of the **Loire Valley**.



ABBAYE DE FONTENAY, BURGUNDY

A beautifully preserved **Cistercian monastery** founded in **1118**. Surrounded by nature, it includes a **Romanesque church, cloister, dormitory, and working forge**. Its peaceful atmosphere and **architectural harmony** reflect the **simple** yet profound lifestyle of the **Cistercian monks**.

Luxury à la **FRANÇAISE**



DEFINING THE ESSENCE OF FRENCH
SOPHISTICATION.



French luxury **stands as a timeless symbol** of sophistication, embodied by iconic brands that have redefined elegance across the world. From the exquisite craftsmanship of **Louis Vuitton's** leather masterpieces to the haute couture brilliance of **Chanel and Dior**, French luxury is built on a legacy of artistry, precision, and passion. It is seen in the glimmer of a **Cartier jewel**, the fragrance of a **Hermès silk scarf**, and the allure of a **Givenchy gown**. Each brand tells a story of heritage and innovation, where tradition meets modern creativity. Beyond fashion, **French luxury represents a lifestyle**—one of refinement, confidence, and timeless grace that continues to inspire the world.

RARE FACTS

About Francophonie COUNTRIES

THE DANCING PLAGUE OF 1518 (STRASBOURG)

Dozens of people began dancing uncontrollably for days, some even **dying** from **exhaustion**. No one knows why—theories include **mass hysteria**, **ergot poisoning**, or **religious mania**.



THE RAIN OF BLOOD (1903)

In **Châtillon-sur-Seine**, villagers reported **rain tinted red**. Scientists later found it was **dust mixed with Sahara sand** carried by wind—but it terrified people at the time.

THE PHANTOM BARBER OF PASCAGOULA

Though in the **US**, it was a **French-founded town**. In the **1940s**, a **mysterious intruder** would cut locks of **people's hair** while they **slept**. The **culprit** was **never caught**.



MANNEKEN PIS'S DISAPPEARANCE

The tiny statue of the **urinating boy** has been **stolen** more than **seven times**—once by **French soldiers** who treated it like a war trophy.

THE EXPLODING CHEESE MYSTERY

In the **19th century**, some **Swiss cheeses** literally **exploded** due to **gas buildup** from **bacteria** when stored improperly. It caused several **cellar fires**.





THE GENEVA GHOST MONKS (1800S)

Locals near an old monastery **reported seeing headless monks** wandering at night. It turned out to be **smugglers** using **costumes** to scare away guards.

FAMADIHANA

The “**Turning of the Bones**” – Every few years, **families exhume their ancestors**, **rewrap** them in **fresh silk**, and **dance** with the **corpses** to **honor** them before reburying.



THE MASS “LAUGHING EPIDEMIC” OF 1962

A **mysterious outbreak** began at a **mission-run school**, causing hundreds of **people to laugh uncontrollably** for days. It spread across villages — psychologists call it a **case of mass psychogenic illness**.

THE VANISHING VILLAGE OF OURANG-MEDAN (1947)

A **Dutch ship**, but discovered by **French and British ships**. Entire **crew found dead** with expressions of **terror**, but with **no wounds**. The ship **exploded mysteriously** before it could be **examined**.



THE CURSED DOLL OF QUÉBEC CITY

A 19th century **doll** kept in a **convent** was said to **move its head** and **change expressions**. It's still **stored in a glass case**; some visitors claim it **blinks**.



THE VANISHING ISLAND OF SAINT-LOUIS

Fishermen reported an **island appearing** at **low tide** and **disappearing** again — **uncharted**, moving with **currents**. Scientists now think it's a **shifting sandbar**, but **no one** knows its **exact origin**.



A Language

woven with *charm and precision*, **French** carries within it the legacy of poets, philosophers, and dreamers. **Each word** seems to glide rather than speak, **expressing not only meaning but elegance**. It is a language that *transforms the ordinary into the extraordinary*- a reflection of France's culture, art, and timeless sophistication.

that breathes

through melodies of conversation and whispers of poetry, **French has an aura unlike any other**. It is alive in cafés along Parisian streets, in the rhythm of *chansons*, and in the soft cadence of its speakers. To hear **French** is to feel grace in motion- gentle, flowing, and endlessly expressive.

beauty,

in **French**, is not just seen but spoken. From **fashion to philosophy, cuisine to cinema**, the language becomes a vessel of art and refinement. It carries **emotion** with poise, turning communication into creation— and in every phrase, it **reminds the world** that *true elegance begins with expression*.

French.

The *beauty of the French Language* lies not **only in the words themselves** but *in the way they breathe—* **soft, fluid, and full of life.** It is a language that *caresses the ear, where even the simplest phrase sounds like a melody born of grace. French carries the warmth of emotion and the precision of thought, balancing intellect with artistry.* Each syllable seems to glide effortlessly, **painting images of love, art, and timeless charm.** To speak **French** is to enter a world where elegance is instinctive and beauty **inevitable.** It is the language of **poets and dreamers, of lovers and thinkers— a voice that has shaped culture, inspired revolutions of the heart, and defined refinement itself.** In **every word** lies an echo of history and a promise of art; in **every sentence, the heartbeat of beauty spoken aloud.**

BEAUTY

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